"the eyes told what the heart tried to hide"



The Message

Danarov Safeen Surchi

The Message

Dar'ov safeen surchi

Chapter One — The Girl Who Said Hello

Hello. My name is Darya. I'm a fifteen-year-old boy living in a country where love is almost forbidden.

Well… maybe *almost* forbidden is a bit dramatic.

But still, it wasn't really the kind of place where you could just say, "Hey, I like you," without thinking your whole life might fall apart.

But that didn't stop me from liking someone whose face felt like it shined brighter than the sun.

Anyway, this is my love story.

It was **November 28th**, around five in the evening, when I got home from school. I was really tired. The kind of tired where your bed just looks perfect.

So I fell asleep right away.

Around seven, my mom woke me up for dinner.

I ate fast, like in ten minutes.
I don’t even really remember the taste.
Then between seven and eight, my phone buzzed.
I got a message on Instagram.
It was from a girl.
Hello, I’m Dilshin from 10th grade. Can we be friends? U look lowkey cool.

I stared at it for a few seconds.
Then I replied, a bit nervous:
hmm

Not a great first impression, honestly.
Then I sent another message.
But ur parents may not like that u have a boy friend?

She replied almost instantly.
They won't know.

I frowned.
And if they find out?

They won't. I promise.

I hesitated.
Sorry, I can't risk this tho.

Then she said something that made me change my mind.
But I wanted to be ur friend so badly.

That hit me weirdly.
I've always had a hard time saying no to people who really want me around.
So I finally said:
OK then.

And that's how we became friends.
We talked that night and got to know each other a bit.

Next day.
I went to school with my guitar on
my back. I was walking when
Dilshin came up to me.
She was wearing a nice dress.
She stopped in front of me.
Hi.

She looked really shy.
Like she didn't know what to do with
herself.
I smiled a little.
Hi.

I looked at her.
Your outfit looks good.

Her face turned red right away.
Like, really red.
I instantly regretted saying it.
She looked away.
Thank yo...

Yeah.

That was awkward.

After school, we went to the shore and sat down.
The sky looked really nice. Blue above, and near the horizon it was red and pink. The wind was soft. It felt calm there.
We didn’t talk much at first.
Then she looked at me.
What do u do mostly?

I smiled.
I like music. I listen to songs and play guitar.

I still had my guitar.
She looked at it.
Her eyes lit up.
Can u play rn?

I grinned.
Sure.

So I played.
One song became two.
Then more.
Time just passed.
I played, talked about music, and told her I wanted to be a guitarist one day.
She listened.
I think she liked it.
Or maybe she was just being nice.
Either way, I was happy.
After a while she said:
You are special, man.

I laughed a little.
Nah, I'm just normal… but thanks.

Then I asked her:
And you? Any talents?

She got excited.
Yeah. I'm kinda an artist.

Then she suddenly looked a bit sad.
But I don't have my drawings with me.

I nodded.
It's okay. When you get home, send them on Instagram.

She nodded.
Then she checked the time.
Her eyes widened.
I gtg. My mom will worry.

I stood up too.
Do you want me to walk you home?

She shook her head fast.
Nah, I'm okay. Thanks.

And she started walking away.
I watched her go.
But every few steps she looked back.
Once.

Twice.
Then again.
Until she disappeared.
I stood there with my guitar, just looking at the empty path.
I didn’t know it then…
But that small talk by the shore was the start of something bigger than both of us.
Chapter Two — The Guardian Angel
Our friendship continued like that.
Well… *mostly* through Instagram.
We barely met in person because of the kind of society we lived in. Some people genuinely believed that a girl and a boy being friends was enough to bring shame to their entire families.
Apparently, friendship was dangerous now.
So, naturally, we just kept talking online.

And honestly, Dilshin's shyness

never really left.
Even after becoming friends, most of our conversations were just small talk.
“How was your day?”
“What are you doing?”
“Did you eat?”
That kind of stuff.
Nothing too serious.
Until one evening, while we were talking, I suddenly asked her:

Do u believe in love?

She replied:
Yeah, I do. What about you?

I answered quickly:
Yeah. And I also think someone's lover is their guardian angel, yk what I mean?

She took a moment before asking:

Have u found ur guardian angel yet?

I replied:
Nah. And you?

She said:
I guess so.

I raised an eyebrow at my phone.
How old is he?

She replied:
Around my age. Maybe a lil younger.

I stared at that message.
Okay.
Interesting.
I asked:
Does he know about that?

This time, she didn't answer immediately.
Almost two minutes passed.
Then:

I have left enough clues for him to notice.

I smiled.
And if he hasn't noticed yet?

Her answer came surprisingly quickly.
Then it's between him and the Lord.

I don't know why, but that sentence made me laugh.
That was definitely one way to confess without actually confessing.
Unfortunately, I had to leave, so I ended the conversation.
But the next evening, we somehow ended up talking about the same thing again.
I asked:
How does he look?

She replied:

I don't really like talking about his looks, but I know his height. He's around 170.

I paused.
170?
That was basically my height.
At this point, I was starting to notice the clues.
And honestly, I already suspected she liked me before she even started talking about his height.
But I decided to keep playing dumb.
Because apparently, I enjoyed making my own life unnecessarily complicated.
So I asked:
What if he has two crushes? Like, one is you, but he likes another girl too?

Yeah.
I asked that because, unfortunately, I had found another girl attractive after

meeting Dilshin.
I wasn't trying to hide anything.
I was just curious what she would say.
Her answer came quickly:
Then I don't want him. If he liked me, then he'd be mine.

Then another message appeared:
I don't force him. It's his choice who he likes.

I thought about that for a moment.
Then I asked:
And if he waits for u to tell him first?

She replied:
I'm not gonna do that. I don't move first. He's the man, and he has to tell me first.

I smiled at my phone.
Yeah, completely agree.

Then, after a few seconds, I sent another message.
Do u know I think I've found my guardian angel?

She immediately asked:
Who is she?

I smiled.
Well… round eyes, dark hair, white skin, shortie.

I had described her pretty well.
Except for one tiny problem.
Her hair wasn't actually dark.
It was dark brown.
Close enough.
Probably.
She asked:
Are u sure she has dark hair?

I replied:
Not really lol 😂

And that was it.
We both went offline.
I went to sleep thinking about the conversation.
Maybe she knew.
Maybe I knew.
Maybe we both knew and were just pretending we didn't.
Either way, neither of us said anything.

December 20th
The next morning, we started talking again.
After a few questions, she began describing me.
She kept mentioning little things about me, one after another.
The more she described me, the more suspicious I became.
Finally, I asked:
Is that me?

She replied:
Who knows?

I stared at the screen.
Then I answered:
Me.

And then she finally said it.
I like you.

I wasn't exactly shocked.
Honestly, by that point, I had already figured it out.
Still, seeing those words on my screen felt different.
I didn't know what to say.
So I waited.
Then I replied honestly:
I need time. I don't know what I'm feeling.

There was no anger.

No pressure.
She simply replied:
Ofc. Take ur time. I don't force you.

And somehow, that answer meant more to me than a thousand dramatic love confessions could have.
For the first time, I realized something.
Maybe this wasn't just a friendship anymore.
Maybe Dilshin really was the guardian angel she had been talking about.
And maybe…
I was starting to become hers.

Chapter Three — The Answer

I was sitting at my desk, supposedly studying.
Well…

Not actually studying.
I had spent the entire time staring at my books while my brain was somewhere completely different.
I kept thinking about her.
Is she the one?
Am I even in a situation where I can have a relationship?
Is it too early?
Do we even know each other well enough to have these feelings?
Damn it.
These questions were driving me crazy.
I didn't even know where they were coming from.
So instead of answering them, I decided to think about something much simpler.
She's pretty.
She's shy.
She's nothing like the others.
She's respectful.
And, as far as I know, she isn't really

interested in boys like that.
I stared at my desk for a few seconds.
Then the question came back.
Is she the one?
I smiled.
Then I suddenly punched the desk.
"Hell yeah."

Yeah.
That was apparently my way of making important life decisions.
I grabbed my phone immediately.
I opened Instagram.
And I told her the exact same thing she had told me earlier.
I like you too.

Chapter Four — Getting to Know Her

Just like that, we ended up in a relationship.

And honestly… we talked **a lot**.

Like, **9–12 hours a day** kind of a lot.
At that point, I probably spent more time talking to her than doing anything remotely productive.
And earning her trust wasn't even that difficult.
After only three days of being together, she had already started telling me all kinds of her secrets.
I was *really* good at keeping secrets.
Even now, while I'm telling this story to you guys, I'm not going to tell you what kind of secrets she told me.
Mostly because I respect her privacy.
...
And also because I forgot most of them. •_•
Anyway, let's continue.
I kept asking her about everything.
Her hobbies.
Her favorite things.
Things she liked.
Things she hated.
Basically, **everything**.

And she kept telling me literally everything.

One day, we were walking home from school together.
People were staring at us like we'd just committed a crime.
Honestly, the way they were looking at us, you'd think we had murdered somebody.
But we didn't care.
Not anymore.
We kept walking.
After a while, I looked at her.
She had been quiet for quite some time.
Well, you've been silent for long enough. Don't u agree?

She quietly answered:
Idk what to say.

I thought for a moment.
Hmm...

Then, for some reason, I decided to ask one of the worst possible questions.
Tell me about some bad things that have ever happened to you.

She looked down at her shoes.
Then she smiled.
She slowly looked back at me, and there was something different in her eyes.
Almost like she was looking at old memories.
She said quietly:
Many bad things have happened to me.

I immediately looked forward.
Why did I ask that?
I felt embarrassed and guilty for bringing up such a stupid question.
But then I stopped.
She stopped too.

She looked at me with confused eyes.
What?

I took a step closer.
I gently grabbed her hand and said:
Then I promise you, I shall never be another bad thing for you.

She blushed.
Badly.
Like, *someone-check-her-temperature* badly.
For a second, I genuinely thought she was going to explode.
I've never seen someone turn that red before.
She smiled, looked away, and continued walking.
Then, in her shy little voice, she muttered:
Idiot.

I smiled.

I knew she was shy, so I decided not to interrogate her with any more dumb questions.
Instead, I just kept talking beside her.
Eventually, her shyness faded away.
Then she suddenly said:
Soooo...

I looked at her.
I was completely clueless.
There was nothing to talk about.
And that was weird for me.
I was usually the guy who kept conversations alive.
With my friend group, I was always the one making jokes and bringing up random topics.
Even when we'd all be together at night, some people would be eating, some would be sleeping, and others would be scrolling on their phones.
And they'd tell me:
Do nothing. Just talk to us.

Apparently, I was the group's
personal radio station.
But with her?
I was a completely different person.
She said:
Soooo...

I replied:
Sooo...

Brilliant.
Absolutely brilliant conversation
skills.
She thought for a second.
Then she asked:
When's ur birthday?

I answered:
1 July. Yours?

She smiled.
3 September.

And just like that, we had a topic.
Not exactly the most romantic conversation in history...
But hey, at least nobody was staring at us like we'd committed murder anymore.
Eventually, we reached her house first.
She stopped near the door and turned around to look at me.
Anyways, thanks for walking me home. Goodbye.

I waved my hand.
See ya around.

She nodded and went inside.
I stood there for a moment before turning around and walking home.
And the entire way back...
I kept thinking about her.

I read her words.
Then I started typing again.
And this time, I wasn't joking.
Please, if anytime I wasn't enough for you, tell me. Tell me I should change. Tell me every bad detail about me. I'll change for u. I'll get better or worse or however u like it. Just don't leave like I saw in my dreams.

Looking back, those were just a few words on a screen.
But I meant every single one of them.
I didn't want to lose her.
Not after everything we'd started building together.
I wanted to be enough for her. I wanted her to feel happy with me.
And if there was something wrong with me, I wanted to know so I could

fix it.
Maybe I was overthinking.
Maybe I was being dramatic.
Okay, fine. I was **definitely** being dramatic.
But I was fifteen, in love, and apparently already worrying about losing someone I'd only recently started dating.
Give me a break.
Then her messages arrived.
Babeeee..!

Another one.
Babyyyyyy!

And then:
You are already the definition of perfection.

I smiled at my phone.
But she wasn't finished.
I love you, idiot. Don't ever say such things like that.

I read those messages again.
And again.
And probably one more time, just to make sure my eyes weren't malfunctioning.
Then I replied:
I love u too.

And just like that, my worries became a little quieter.
I still had plenty to learn about love.
I still had plenty to learn about her.
And I definitely had plenty to learn about myself.
But that morning, with nothing more than a few messages on a screen, Dilshin made me feel like I didn't have to be perfect to be loved.
Even if she insisted that I was.
And honestly?
I wasn't going to argue with my girlfriend about that.
I wasn't that stupid mate.

Chapter Six — The Eyes That Told Our Story

Two months passed.

We kept talking every day, every hour, every spare second we could steal. Honestly, I was starting to believe that if the internet ever disappeared, half of our relationship would collapse with it. 😭🤦‍♀️

Then, one evening, she sent me a photo.

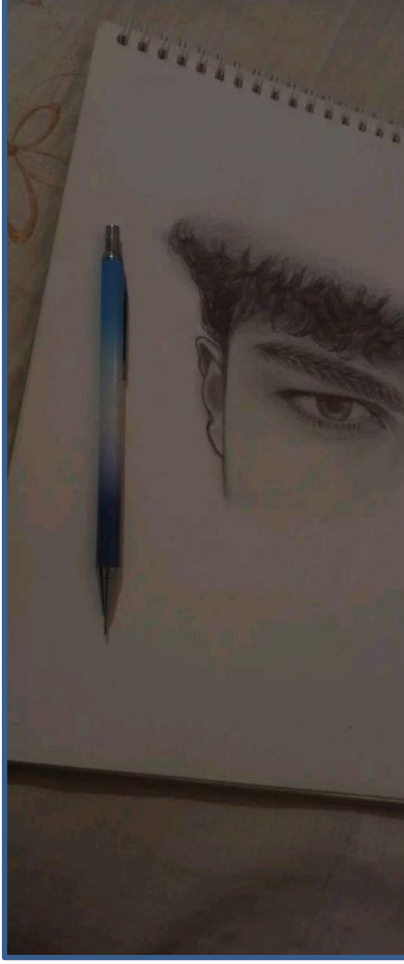
It was a picture of my eye.

She texted:

— Hey, look. Is it beautiful? 😏

I stared at the photo.

I stared at it again.



And then, with the confidence of a man
who had absolutely no idea
what was happening, I replied:

— Yeah, but whose eye is it?

She answered almost immediately.

— It's YOU, dumbass 😭😂

OH, SHI—

I had just failed to recognize my own eye. My own. The eye I had been carrying around since birth. 😭✌
□💔

I quickly replied:

— Ow shi—
— I didn't even recognize my eye ✌
□💔

She came back with the most loving response imaginable:

— Bcz u are dumb as hell lol 😭✌□

— Yeah, yeah, I get it. Whatever.

I could practically hear her laughing through the screen.

But then I looked at the picture again. It was a little thing, really—a photo of my eye. Yet she'd taken the time to send it to me, and somehow, that made it special.

So I told her:

— Thank you, btw. It means a lot.
— I will keep it forever.

— You're welcome.

And I meant it. I wasn't going to throw it away. That picture was staying with me.

After all, imagine telling someone years later that your girlfriend once sent you a picture of your own eye

and you failed to recognize it. A priceless memory. A tragic memory, perhaps, but priceless nonetheless. 😢

Then, out of nowhere, a question came to my mind.

— If our love story was a book, what title would it have?

She gave me several suggestions.

Miles Away...

The Eyes Are Telling What the Hearts Tried to Hide...

And a few others.

There were quite a lot, actually. But that second title caught my eye.

The Eyes Are Telling What the Hearts Tried to Hide.

It was beautiful. It sounded like the title of a real romance novel—the kind you'd find on a shelf and pick up because the title alone made you curious.

Of course, it needed a few updates. But the idea was there.

Two people, trying to understand each other. Two hearts, slowly getting closer. And eyes that might have revealed feelings their owners weren't ready to admit.

Funny, considering I couldn't even recognize my own eye.

Anyway.

I had another question.

— Ur fav color?

She replied:

— Burgundy.

That was it.

One word. No explanation. No dramatic paragraph about the mysterious beauty of burgundy. Just burgundy.

Yeah. She was casual in the best possible way. 😭

I replied:

— Got it.

And yes, I did.

I got it.

I wasn't asking just to make

conversation. I wanted to know the little things about her—the things that might seem unimportant to everyone else but somehow mattered to me.

Her favorite color. Her favorite things. The little details that made her her.

Because two months earlier, she had been just a girl who sent me a message on Instagram.

Now, I was collecting little pieces of her like they were treasures.

And maybe they were.

I still had a lot to learn about her. But I was beginning to understand something: sometimes, love wasn't about grand promises or perfect words.

Sometimes, it was a girl sending you a picture of your own eye.

And you being stupid enough not to recognize it.

Romance really does make a man lose his intelligence. 😭✌🏻 □

Chapter Seven — The Birthday Message

Guess what happened?

We broke up.

Yeah. We did.

Not because we stopped loving each other. Not because we got bored. Not because one of us found someone else.

Nope.

A bitchass classmate decided to tell our teachers about us, and they threatened to tell our families.

And just like that, everything changed.

On May 7th, we broke up. ✌□✌□✌□

Not because we wanted to. We were forced into a situation where staying together could bring trouble to our families. So we did what we thought we had to do.

We stopped talking.

We barely even saw each other at school. And when we did, it was as if we were strangers who had never shared anything.

She blocked me everywhere.

At school, she wouldn't even look at me for a second.

And me? Well, I had no idea what she was thinking. I started believing she'd forgotten me, or worse, that she hated me.

After all, we'd been together for

months. From those first awkward conversations to talking for hours every day, we'd built something that mattered to me. And now, suddenly, I couldn't even ask her how her day had been.

Honestly, I thought I was just another chapter she'd decided to close.

Until June 10th.

My birthday.

A month after everything ended.

At 10:32 p.m., my phone received a message.

It was from her.

I opened it.

And there it was.

«Hey my boy, hey beautiful little baby boy,
Im sorry cz im not there for u my love,
In this day…
The one i ever loved was born,
The one, that cant any one be like ever,
The one that was with me every time i needed him,
The one… I wish i never hurt..
The one I wish i never let go of..
But I didn't have a choice, im sorry my love,
Forgive me for what i did..
Happy birthday My handsome,
Happy birthday My friend,
Happy birthday My baby boy,
Happy birthday My everything,
Enjoy your day My prince,
My king,
My soulmate,

I said ill forget u, but distance says different things…
Words are easy, but not actions…
I want u to live ur life, like u never met me,
Love u so much □»

...

Yeah.

I was shocked.

Like, genuinely shocked.

All this time, I'd been telling myself that she hated me. She had blocked me everywhere. At school, she wouldn't look at me, not even for a second. I'd convinced myself that she wanted nothing to do with me anymore.

Then, on my birthday, she sent me

that.

How was I supposed to react?

I didn't know whether to smile, cry, stare at my phone, or throw it across the room and pretend I had never learned how to read.

The worst part?

That message made me sadder than the breakup itself.

Because the breakup had taken her away from me. But that message reminded me that maybe, just maybe, she hadn't wanted to leave in the first place.

And somehow, that hurt even more.

So what did I reply?

Did I write a beautiful paragraph? Did I tell her how much I'd missed her? Did I finally say everything I'd been keeping inside for a whole month?

Of course not.

I asked:

— Is it for me?

...

I KNOW. 😭

What kind of question was that?!

Who else was she talking about? The president? Her math teacher? Some random guy who happened to be born on the same day as me?

But apparently, my brain had decided

that the best way to respond to the most emotional birthday message of my life was to question whether it was even meant for me.

Romantic genius. Absolutely unmatched.

Thirty-two minutes later, she replied:

— What do u think?

Fair enough. I deserved that.

And then, instead of recovering from my previous mistake, I decided to make another one.

With all the confidence of a man who had absolutely no confidence, I answered:

— I don't really know what I am thinking tbh.

...

I COULD HAVE SAID
ANYTHING ELSE. 😭✌🏻💔

I could've told her I'd missed her. I could've thanked her properly. I could've told her that I hadn't forgotten her either.

But no.

I gave her a sentence that sounded like my brain had been disconnected from the rest of my body.

She replied:

— Really? I thought you knew.

And that was when I realized my answer had hurt her.

I didn't mean to. I wasn't trying to act like I didn't care. I was just overwhelmed, confused, and completely unprepared for the possibility that she still had feelings for me.

So I said:

— Ohh.

Then:

— Sorry. Thanks for sending it, really.

She replied:

— You're welcome.

And that was it.

Two people who wanted to talk to each other. Two people who had

missed each other for a whole month. Two people who probably had a thousand things to say.

And all we managed was a few short messages.

We wanted to talk. God, we really did.

We tried, too. But we couldn't.

Maybe we were afraid. Maybe we didn't know what we were allowed to say anymore. Maybe the circumstances that had separated us were still standing between us, even when neither of us wanted them there.

Whatever the reason, we couldn't return to the way things had been.

Not that night.

Not with a birthday message, no matter how beautiful it was.

And after spending roughly four months learning the smallest things about her, I suddenly found myself facing the one thing I had never wanted to learn:

How to miss someone who was still right there in the same world as you, but no longer yours to talk to.

Chapter Eight — Me or Her

Three days.

Only three days after my birthday.

That's how long it took before we talked again.

And this time, I did something terrible.

I friend-zoned her. Not once, not

twice, but so much that I practically built a whole neighborhood in the friend zone and handed her the keys.

But that wasn't even the worst part.

I lied.

Not to her.

To myself.

I told her the harshest words I could think of.

— Do u want me to be honest with you? I don't love u anymore.

And then, as if that wasn't enough, I said:

— It's not ur problem. U just don't have the ability to love.

God.

Those words hurt me like hell.

I'd never lied to her like that before. Not about something that mattered. But this time, I wanted her to hate me. I wanted her to forget me through anger, through resentment, through anything that could help her stop loving someone she couldn't be with.

I wanted her to believe that I'd closed every page I'd ever written her name on.

That I'd moved on.

That our story meant nothing to me anymore.

But the truth?

I never wanted things to end this way.

I just couldn't understand the point of loving someone when you couldn't even have them.

What was the point of two people loving each other if they had to pretend they were strangers? What was the point of holding on to a love that we weren't allowed to live?

I thought that if she hated me, she'd eventually stop hurting.

At least, that was the excuse I gave myself.

She replied:

— Is that what you think?

I said:

— Yes.

One word.

Four letters.

And somehow, it felt heavier than everything I'd ever told her.

I hated my fingers. I hated myself. I hated every second of that conversation.

I hated breaking her heart.

Because once, her heart had been one of the most precious things in my world. She'd trusted me with it. She'd told me she loved me. She'd called me her prince, her king, her soulmate.

And now?

I was the one hurting her.

May the skies fall upon my head and blow me to pieces for breaking that pretty, incredible angel's heart!

I deserved at least a little thunder. Maybe a lightning strike, too. 😷

But apparently, the universe had decided to let me suffer the ordinary way.

And that was only the beginning.

A week later, at school, she started bullying me.

She'd push me down the stairs and say:

— Oops.

In that teasing voice of hers.

Sometimes she'd insult me in every way imaginable. And I never answered back. I never stood up against her.

Why?

Because it was what I wanted.

I'd wanted her to hate me, hadn't I? Well, congratulations, Darya. You ordered hatred, and the universe delivered.

Except there was something strange about it.

Seeing that shy girl suddenly turn into a villain was… surprisingly attractive.

I know. I KNOW. 😳🙈

She'd look at me with that hateful little smile, and somehow, she looked more beautiful than ever. It was like she'd buried every feeling she had for me and replaced them with pure hatred.

But I knew better.

At least, I thought I did.

She was lying.

I was lying.

And somewhere beneath all that anger, I believed we were both still burning for each other.

But what could we do?

We couldn't talk freely. We couldn't be together. We couldn't even look at

each other without remembering everything we'd lost.

And the person who'd started all this?

That classmate who had told our teachers about us?

Let's just say I was furious.

Sometimes, I imagined grabbing her and throwing her into a fire for what she'd done.

Would I actually do it? No. But in my imagination, she was getting a punishment worthy of the greatest villain in history. 😤

Because I was fifteen, heartbroken, and convinced that one person's interference had destroyed the most beautiful thing I'd ever experienced.

Anyway.

Enough about her.

Let's talk about me.

The master of pretending.

I acted like I didn't care about Dilshin. I acted like I'd moved on. I acted like the whole relationship had become nothing more than an old memory.

But every day, I kept posting songs on my Instagram story.

Songs about her.
Every lyric was a message I couldn't send directly. Every line was something I wanted her to understand without having to say her name.

And she watched them.

Every single time.

At least, that's what I noticed.

I don't know whether she understood the lyrics or whether she simply tapped through my stories without thinking much about them. But I kept posting anyway.

Because even though I'd told her I didn't love her anymore, some foolish part of me still wanted her to know that I did.

I wanted her to read between the lines.

To recognize herself in every song.

To understand that the boy who

claimed to have forgotten her was still writing about her every single day.

Then, one day, I posted a song that mentioned her more clearly.

Not her name exactly, but enough to make the meaning obvious.

I waited.

She didn't view it.

At first, I thought nothing of it. Maybe she was busy. Maybe she hadn't opened Instagram yet.

So I posted another.

And another.

For three days, I kept doing it.

And she didn't check.

Not once.

For the first time, I felt genuinely heartbroken.

I thought she'd moved on.

I thought she'd finally stopped looking for me in songs. Maybe she'd stopped caring about the boy who had told her he didn't love her anymore.

And honestly, could I blame her?

I'd practically begged her to forget me. I'd given her every reason to believe that our love had died.

What right did I have to be upset when she finally seemed to let it go?

Still, grief settled deep in my heart.

But I'm not the kind of person who cries easily.

My ego was too high. My pride stood in the way, arms crossed, refusing to let me shed a single tear.

Yet I needed to cry.

God, I needed to cry so badly.

I wanted to let everything out. The anger, the regret, the loneliness, the guilt. I wanted to stop pretending that I was fine when I wasn't.

But every time I thought about crying, my personality gave me the same ridiculous ultimatum:

Me or her!

As if crying over someone I loved meant losing a war.

As if my pride mattered more than my heart.

And so, I kept everything inside.

I don't know whether she truly moved on. I don't know whether she stopped watching my stories because she no longer cared, because she was trying to heal, or because she was simply tired of hurting.

I never asked.

I just assumed.

And perhaps that was another mistake.

I guess we're finished.

At least, that's what I keep telling myself.

But before I close this chapter, there's something I need to say.

Something I couldn't say to her when we still had the chance.

Something I wish she could hear, even if she never does.

A Letter to Dilshin

Dear Dilshin,

I hope you're fine.

And I hope you're reading this.

I love you so much.

I'm sorry for breaking your heart. I'm sorry for forcing you to believe that I'd abandoned our love. I'm sorry for telling you that I didn't love you anymore when, deep down, I couldn't imagine how to stop.

But for me, this has never been the end.

Never.

Do you really think I'm so weak that I'd let one student destroy our entire love story?

No, my love. No.

They ended our conversations.

They stopped us from talking freely. They made us hide from the people who should never have had the power to decide what we felt.

But they didn't erase what happened between us.

They didn't erase the memories.

They didn't erase the songs.

And they didn't erase you from my heart.

One day, I hope I'll see you in a white dress, and I'll be standing there as your groom.

I don't know what the future holds. I don't know how many obstacles we'll face, or whether life will give us the chance to find our way back to each other.

But I know that what I felt for you was real.

And I refuse to pretend that it wasn't.

I don't care how many times they silence us. My love is louder than my loudest music. My screams are louder than any voice that has ever tried to drown me out.

I love you, my perfect, beautiful girl.

I'm sorry.

For everything.

Darya to Dilshin. ❤